SINGAPORE SCHOOL KINDERLAND

Primary-6 Information Technology (IT) • Term 1

CHAPTER 1: MS ACCESS 2010 • STUDY MATERIAL (PAGES 5 TO 8)

1. STARTING MS ACCESS 2010

To open Microsoft Access 2010 on your computer, follow these simple steps:
Step 1: Click on the **Start button**.
Step 2: Click on **All Programs**.
Step 3: Click on **Microsoft Office**.
Step 4: Click on **Microsoft Office Access 2010**.
The MS Access 2010 application window will now open on your screen.

2. CREATING A DATABASE IN MS ACCESS 2010

In MS Access 2010, you can create a database in **2 ways**:
1. **Using a Blank database:** Creates a fresh, empty database where you can design your own tables.
2. **Using Sample templates:** Creates a ready-made database with pre-designed tables, forms, and reports (for example, the *Faculty* template).

Steps to Create a Blank Database:

1. In the default MS Access window, **Blank database** is already selected.
2. Type a name for your database in the **File Name** box.
3. (Optional) You can change the folder location of your database by clicking on the **Browse icon** (folder icon).
4. Click on the **Create button**.
5. A new table titled **Table1** will be created automatically in **Datasheet View** with a default field named **ID**.

📌 **FACT FILE: The file extension of a database file created in MS Access 2010 is `.accdb`**

3. COMPONENTS OF MS ACCESS 2010 WINDOW

Component	Description & Purpose
Title Bar	Located at the top of the window. It shows the name of the active database. It also contains the **Minimize**, **Maximize/Restore Down**, and **Close** buttons.
File Menu	Located on the left of the Title Bar. It contains basic file management commands such as **New**, **Open**, **Save**, and **Print**.
Quick Access Toolbar	Contains frequently used shortcut commands like **Save**, **Undo**, and **Redo**. It can also be moved below the Ribbon.
Ribbon	Located below the Title Bar. It contains all commands organized into different **tabs** (Home, Create, External Data, Database Tools) and **groups**.
Navigation Pane	Located on the left side of the window. It displays all the database objects (Tables, Queries, Forms, Reports) in the currently opened database.
Tabbed Document	Database objects appear in neat tabs across the top of the work area, making it easy to switch between open tables and forms.

Component	Description & Purpose
Status Bar	Located at the very bottom of the window. It displays status information and buttons to switch between different page views.

4. DATA TYPES IN MS ACCESS 2010

> The **Data Type** for every field describes the type of information that can be entered into that column.

Data Type	Description	Example
AutoNumber	An integer that automatically generates a unique increasing number when a new record is added.	Student Roll No. / ID
Text	Stores alphanumeric values (both letters and numbers). It can store up to a maximum of **255 characters**.	Student Name, Address, Product Code
Memo	Used for lengthy text and descriptive notes. It can store up to a maximum of **65,536 characters**.	Definitions, Remarks, Book Summary
Number	Holds numeric data used for mathematical calculations. Both integer numbers and decimals are allowed.	Marks, Age, Price
Date/Time	Stores dates and time values in different standard formats.	Date of Birth, Admission Date